

CANTON DEV FUND STRATEGY

DPM Debug: Grant Proposal Strategy

Analysis of approved Canton Dev Fund proposals and a strategy for Lazer's first grant submission, a visual debugging plugin for Daml.

Lazer Technologies · Internal Strategy Deck · April 2026

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1,000,000 CC over 16 weeks

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PART 1: APPROVED PROPOSALS

What the Foundation Has Funded

Eight approved PRs from the Canton Dev Fund, analyzed at \$0.15 per CC.

PR	PROPOSAL	PROPOSER	CC AMOUNT	USD VALUE	TIMELINE
#159	CCTools Community Toolkit	0xScoutr	500,000	\$75,000	5 months
#130	Daml Package Analyzer	Certora	2,010,000	\$301,500	5 months
#53	ISS-Based BFT Ordering	Digital Asset	Undisclosed	Est. \$500K+	8 months
#49	Daml OS Maintenance	Digital Asset	1,000,000/mo	\$150,000/mo	Recurring
#48	Canton OS Maintenance	Digital Asset	2,000,000/mo	\$300,000/mo	Recurring
#47	Splice OS Maintenance	Digital Asset	1,000,000/mo	\$150,000/mo	Recurring
#32	Daml3 Training Program	Obsidian Systems	5,290,000	\$740,600	34 weeks
#24	Multi-VM Canton (EVM)	Zenith	2,000,000/mo	\$300,000/mo	12 months

How They Structured Milestones

CC

CCTools (#159)

3 milestones, front-loaded: 200K CC (40%) in M1 for core learn-to-earn platform. 175K for infra and DeFi dashboard. 125K for API and mobile PWA.



Certora (#130)

4 milestones, back-loaded: 335K CC each for M1 and M2 (build + initial adoption). 670K each for M3 and M4 (tied to 5+ production deployments each).



Obsidian (#32)

4 milestones over 34 weeks. 5,290,000 CC total (revised down 20% from original \$927K ask). Modules, certification exams, and 12 coding videos.



DA Maintenance

PRs #47, #48, #49: rolling monthly milestones. 1M to 2M CC/mo for ongoing repo maintenance. Acceptance: response times, release cadence, PR reviews.

What Gets Approved and Why

STRUCTURE
3 to 5 Milestones

Fixed-scope projects use 3 to 5 milestones with explicit, testable acceptance criteria. Not vague deliverables, but conditions like "5 production deployments" or "API accessible with validator tier active."

FRAMING
Public Good Infra

Every approved proposal is framed as public-good infrastructure or core protocol work. Dapps and use-case demos are borderline. Open-source licensing (MIT or Apache 2.0) is table stakes.

CHAMPIONS
Named Sponsor

Every proposal has a champion from the Foundation or committee. We are engaging the Tech & Ops Committee to secure ours as we iterate on feedback.

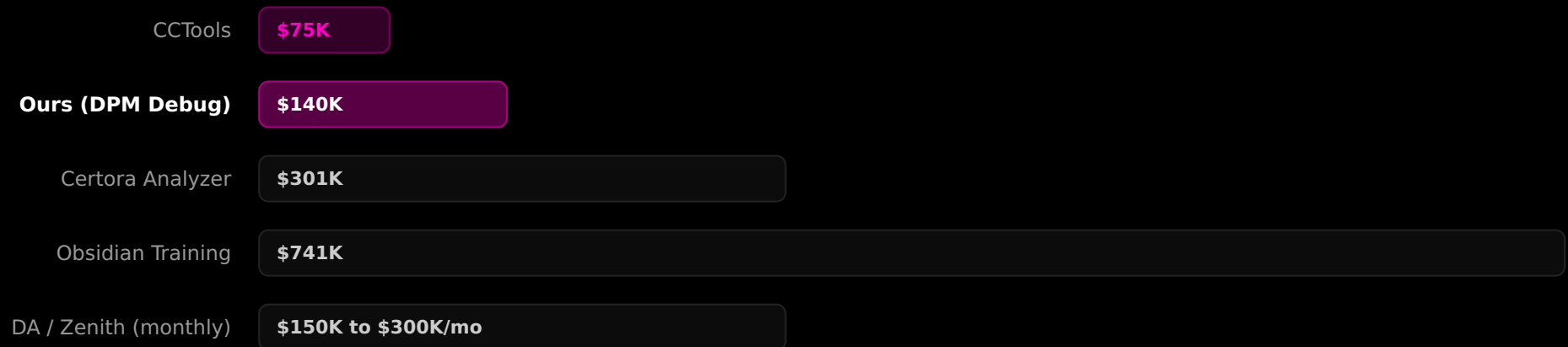
CREDIBILITY
Prove It First

CCTools had 20K users before applying. Obsidian voluntarily cut scope by 20%. The strongest proposals show cost discipline and traction, not just ambition.

PART 2: PATTERNS

Grant Budget Landscape

Where our \$140K ask sits relative to approved proposals.



- **\$140K is modest and credible** for a first proposal. Above the floor, well below specialized tooling asks. 80% unlocked in the first two milestones.

Why a Debugger, Why Now

"A really, really good debugging experience is what lacks on top of Canton. If you ask me personally what I would love to see in the ecosystem, I would say a really good debugging experience."

Jatin Pandya, Canton Foundation

Call with Lazer, April 14, 2026

- **Foundation DX survey** flagged "visual debugging" and "transaction visibility" as top missing tools
- **Foundation engagement:** the team offered to review drafts and give feedback as we iterate through the process

COMPLEMENTARY, LAYERED STACK

Walnut (#327/#382) = Trace + Debug Primitives

CLI trace, trace bundles, interactive debugger, compiler debug metadata. The low-level foundation.

Ours = Visual Workbench Layer

Remix-style local web UI: node explorer, transaction trees, test reports. Renders Walnut's trace artifacts under the hood.

Certora = Compile-Time Static Analysis

Security auditing of .dar files before deployment. Different layer entirely.

InfraSingularity (#297) = Failure Diagnosis

Decodes rejected submissions into plain-language causes. Different problem, different moment.

Proposed Grant Structure

16 weeks, 3 milestones. 80% unlocked in M1 and M2.

DURATION

16 weeks

GRANT ASK

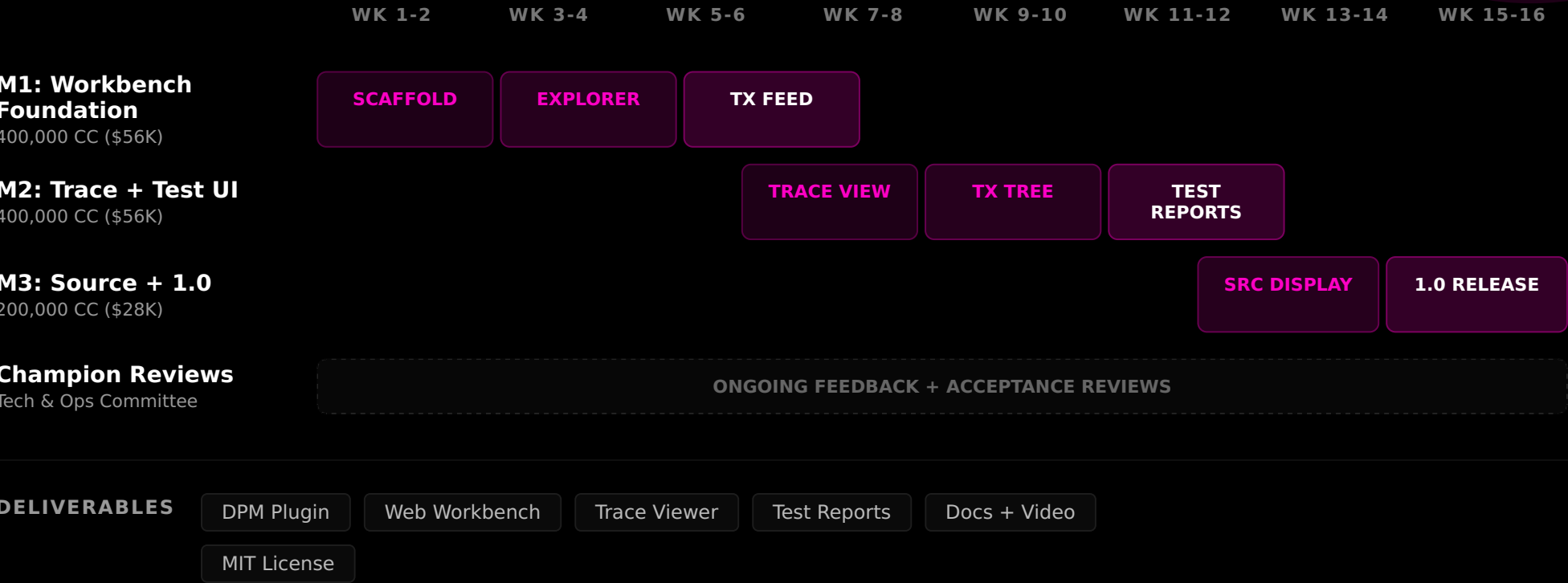
1,000,000 CC
(~\$140K)

PAYOUT

Milestone-based in CC

MILESTONE	FOCUS	DURATION	CC	USD
M1	Workbench foundation: DPM plugin + local web app, participant explorer, live transaction feed	6 weeks	400,000	\$56,000
M2	Visual trace explorer (renders dpm trace artifacts + bundles), log panel, visual test reports with assertion diffs	6 weeks	400,000	\$56,000
M3	Source-aware display (consumes Walnut debug metadata), end-to-end docs, walkthrough video, 1.0 release	4 weeks	200,000	\$28,000
Total		16 weeks	1,000,000	\$140,000

16-Week Delivery Timeline



Why This Wins



Builds on the Stack

Extends Foundation-funded DPM and renders Walnut's dpm trace artifacts and debug metadata. We consume the ecosystem's formats instead of competing with them.



#1 Cited Gap

The Foundation's own DX survey and direct Foundation feedback both identify visual debugging and transaction visibility as the biggest missing piece in the Daml developer experience.



Right Layer for Us

Product-grade developer UX is Lazer's core strength. Compiler and trace primitives stay with the team best suited for them (Walnut); the visual layer is ours.



Credible First Ask

\$140K (\$8.75K/week over 16 weeks), with 80% unlocked in M1 and M2. Positions Lazer for larger follow-up proposals after we deliver.